

Quotation marks “ ”

QUOTATION MARKS INDICATE DIRECT SPEECH OR QUOTED MATERIAL.

Quotation marks, sometimes simply called quotes, are always used in pairs. In addition to indicating speech or a quotation, they can also signal unusual words.

SEE ALSO

◀ 88–89	Direct and indirect speech
◀ 96–99	Commas
◀ 102–103	Colons
Italics	122–123 ▶
Reading and commenting on texts	192–193 ▶
Writing to inform	196–197 ▶
Writing to analyze or review	206–207 ▶
Writing a narrative	212–213 ▶

Direct speech

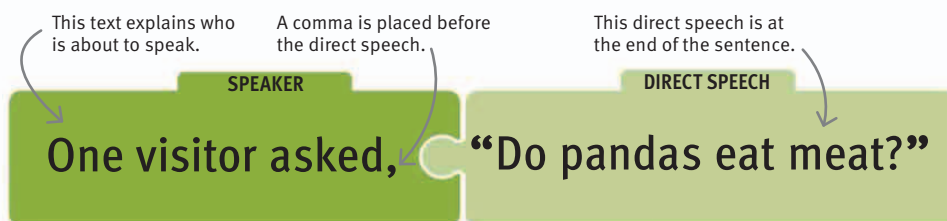
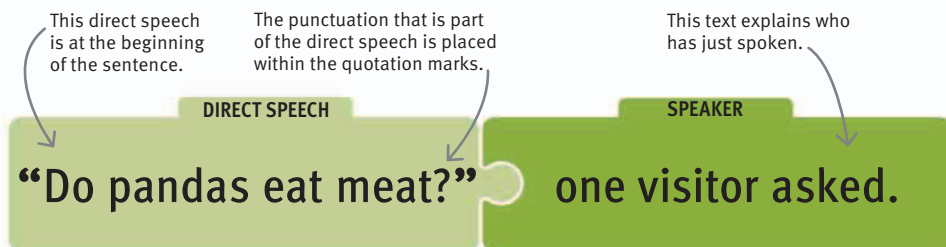
Quotation marks surround direct speech (text that represents spoken words). The material within quotation marks can be split into two sections at either end of the sentence, with text in the middle to explain who is speaking. Quoted material can also be placed at the beginning, in the middle, or at the end of a sentence.

GLOSSARY

Direct speech Text that represents spoken words.

Italics A style of type in which the letters are printed at an angle to resemble handwriting.

Quotation Text that reproduces another author's exact words.



Do pandas eat meat?



Unusual words

Quotation marks can be used to separate particular words or phrases within text. These can indicate that another author's words are being used, that the words are unusual, or that the author does not take the expression seriously.

The zookeeper said that the panda show was “thrilling,” but three pandas were asleep.

The writer has placed quotation marks around this word to suggest that he or she did not find the show as thrilling as expected, based on how it had been described.